Gerardo Cipriano

Cloud Engineer | Google Cloud (GCP), GKE, Terraform, GitOps

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SUMMARY

Cloud Engineer with 3 years building and running Kubernetes platforms on Google Cloud Platform (GCP), and 8+ years in IT since 2018. I provision Google Kubernetes Engine (GKE) infrastructure with Terraform, deliver to it with GitOps (Argo CD, Kargo) and CI/CD, and upgrade it without downtime. Help desk and system administrator roots: I care about backups, restores and the person filing the ticket. Google Cloud Associate Cloud Engineer and Azure Administrator Associate, both valid through 2027.

SKILLS

Google Cloud: Google Kubernetes Engine (GKE) Autopilot and Standard, Cloud SQL, Cloud Storage (GCS) and Cloud Storage FUSE, Certificate Manager, Cloud DNS, Cloud Run, Cloud Build, Cloud Load Balancing, IAM

Kubernetes: Helm, Gateway API, Ingress, Kubernetes RBAC, Network Policy, cluster upgrades, Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), kind

Infrastructure as Code (IaC) and GitOps: Terraform (modular, on Google Cloud and Azure), Argo CD, Argo CD Image Updater, Kargo, Kustomize

CI/CD: GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Azure DevOps, Jenkins (lab)

Scripting and containers: Bash, Python, Git, Docker, Linux

Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, Cloud Monitoring alert policies

Systems: VMware ESXi, Microsoft Hyper-V, Windows Server, Active Directory, Microsoft 365, Veeam Backup & Replication

EXPERIENCE

Cloud Engineer / DevOps Specialist

Dinova S.r.l., Bologna, Italy | Sep 2023 - Present

- Build GCP infrastructure for multi-tenant SaaS clients with modular Terraform (Infrastructure as Code): GKE Autopilot clusters, shared and dedicated Cloud SQL, Certificate Manager for TLS certificates and automatic Cloud DNS records, packaged as reusable Helm charts.
- Upgraded Kubernetes from v1.24 to v1.30, six minor versions, on on-prem and cloud clusters with zero downtime.
- Implemented GitOps continuous delivery with Argo CD and Argo CD Image Updater in several production environments, automating promotion of new container images from CI build to the live environment.
- Migrated traffic routing from Kubernetes Ingress to Gateway API, and moved applications between Kubernetes clusters without service disruption.
- Migrated legacy virtual machine workloads to containerized microservices on GKE and AKS.
- Replaced NFS with Cloud Storage FUSE (GCS Fuse) as the shared storage layer for client workloads on GKE.
- Run CI/CD pipelines on GitHub Actions, GitLab CI and Azure DevOps, and remove pipeline bottlenecks with Python and Bash scripts.
- Designed Helm charts for clients moving to microservices, with rollback support and per-environment configuration.
- Operate GKE and Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) environments: storage, networking, container registry, monitoring and alerting, and Kubernetes RBAC.
- Explore AI agent orchestration and LLM-based automation inside DevOps workflows.

System Administrator

F.T.P. S.r.l., Formigine, Italy | Jul 2020 - Sep 2022

- Administered virtual and on-premises infrastructure for small and mid-sized businesses: VMware ESXi, Microsoft Hyper-V, Windows Server, Active Directory, Group Policy (GPO), WSUS, DHCP and DNS.

- Ran backup and disaster recovery with Veeam Backup & Replication, and managed Sophos and Fortinet FortiGate firewalls and Libraesva and Sophos email antispam.
- Migrated client organizations to Microsoft 365 on my own, and managed Microsoft 365 and Google Workspace tenants.
- Reorganized Active Directory, GPO, WSUS and Hyper-V environments to Microsoft best practices.

IT Help Desk Technician
GPI S.p.A., Modena, Italy | Mar 2018 - Jun 2020

- Provided on-site and remote hardware and software support for public-sector clients: City of Modena, Policlinico di Modena hospital, University of Modena and Reggio Emilia (UniMoRe) and AUSL Modena.
- Rolled out the move from Windows XP and Windows 7 to Windows 10 at Policlinico di Modena and UniMoRe to meet AGID (Italian Digital Agency) requirements.

CERTIFICATIONS

Google Cloud Certified Associate Cloud Engineer (ACE), Google Cloud | First certified Nov 2023, valid through Nov 2027

Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104), Microsoft | First certified 2022, renewed Dec 2025, valid through Dec 2027

Earlier certifications: Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA); Microsoft 365 Identity and Services (Exam MS-100)

PROJECTS

GitOps lab in one command (2026)
github.com/gerardocipriano/gke-gitlab-argocd-all-in-one-setup

Bash tool that bootstraps a complete GitOps environment on kind or GKE with one command: GitLab CE as the Git server, Argo CD with the app-of-apps pattern, and Kargo promoting releases from dev to staging to prod. On GKE the control plane is reachable only through its DNS endpoint with IAM. Includes a 10-step guided demo and a guided teardown.

bekky, encrypted workstation backups (2026)
github.com/gerardocipriano/bekky

Backup and restore of OS configuration to Google Cloud Storage: AES-256 encryption with PBKDF2 at 600,000 iterations, deduplication before encryption, secrets in a separate archive, Nearline storage with lifecycle rules and versioning to keep storage cost low, scheduled runs with alerts, automated testing with bats. README benchmark: about 24 GB of configuration stored as about 100 MB of backup.

Terraform deployment of a web app on Google Cloud (2023)
github.com/gerardocipriano/deploy-terraform-gcp-prenotiamo

University project: Terraform that deploys a Nuxt 3 app on Cloud Run with regional Cloud SQL for high availability, a global load balancer, Cloud Build triggers and alert policies, documented with an architecture diagram.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Information Systems Technology (Tecnologie dei sistemi informatici), University of Bologna, Cesena, Italy | 2021 - 2024

High School Diploma, Telecommunications Technician, IIS F. Corni, Modena, Italy | 2012 - 2017 | Grade 92/100

LANGUAGES

Italian (native) | English (professional working proficiency, B2/C1)